

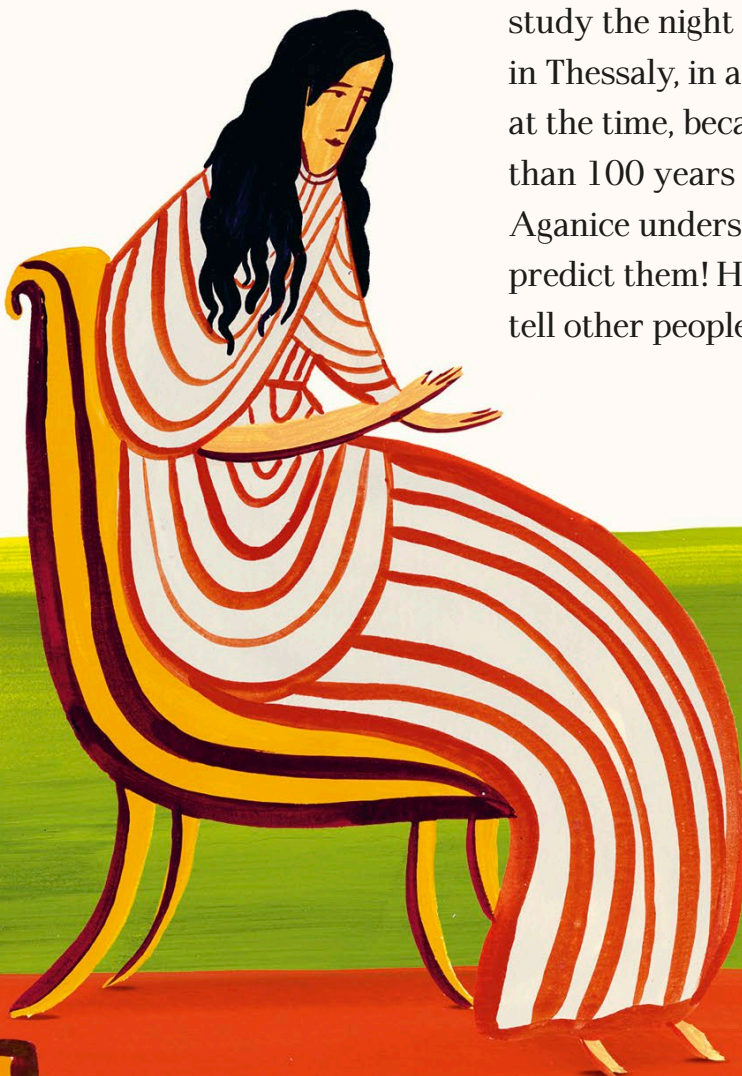


AGANICE OF THESSALY

Greek astronomer • c.3rd century BCE

Very little is known about Aganice of Thessaly, but historians have found clues

that she was one of the first astronomers—scientists who study the night sky. Aganice lived around 2,000 years ago in Thessaly, in ancient Greece. She must have been very famous at the time, because she is mentioned in a book written more than 100 years after she lived. The author, Plutarch, said that Aganice understood lunar eclipses so well that she could predict them! However, he also hinted that Aganice didn't tell other people about the science behind her predictions.



Plutarch wrote that Aganice made people think that she could pull the moon down from the sky! In ancient Greek times, many people would have found this terrifying. Stories linked the moon with strange events and mythical creatures, such as werewolves.

Eclipses are named after the Greek word ekleipō, which means to disappear or cover up.